



Research has found that women with high glucose levels, achieved by eating normally and not skipping breakfast, were more likely to conceive a boy.

CONCEIVING BOYS AND GIRLS

The Shettles method, devised by Dr. Landrum Shettles, is based on the fact that Y sperm (for boys) are smaller, faster, and less resilient than X sperm (for girls), and are less able to withstand an acidic environment in the vagina.

To conceive a boy, the Shettles method advises:

- Timing sex as close to ovulation as possible and adopting positions such as rear-entry that promote deep penetration.
- The woman should orgasm, ideally at the same time as the man to make the vagina less acidic and favor Y sperm.
- Drinking a cup or two of strong coffee just before sex to give Y-sperm an added kick.

The Whelan method, devised by Dr. Elizabeth Whelan, suggests that having sex earlier on in the cycle, some four to six days before ovulation, is more likely to result in a boy. Sex nearer the time of ovulation is more likely to result in a girl. This is more or less the opposite of the advice given by Shettles.

But what works? The mainstream medical view, supported by reports in journals such as the New England Journal of Medicine, is that the timing of sex has little or no bearing on gender. The